group of stretcher bearers whose self-imposed duty it was to collect and provide care for wounded soldiers from both sides of the fight. In many cases, the group was barricaded from helping the Zulus, and black members of the stretcher bearers were shot by British soldiers.

Disheartened at humanity's natural tendency toward violence and hierarchy, Gandhi moved out to a farm near Johannesburg and founded Tolstoy Farm. Together with his friend, Hermann Kallenbach, Tolstoy Farm was dedicated to peaceful, communal living and the philosophy of peaceful reform through nonviolence. Mohandas lived at the farm for five years, meditating on his own ideas of ideal politicism and protest, before he was urged to return to India by none other than the leader of the Indian National Congress. He returned, ready to march again with his Indian brothers and sisters in search of independence.

It was Gopal Krishna Gokhale who summoned Gandhi and his family back from South Africa. He took it upon himself to update Gandhi, who was by then revered by international Indian communities as a leader, on the political issues facing India that year, 1915. The Home Rule League was being launched by Annie Besant, and throughout the country, Indians were asking themselves whether there was anything to be gained from remaining a colony of Great Britain. The Independent India movement started to gain traction, especially under the influence of Gandhi.

Before he could succeed in separating India from Great Britain, however, Gandhi had to unite his own people to work together toward the betterment of India. He traveled to Champaran in 1917 to help the local, impoverished farmers as they made demands on the British administration. His diplomacy brought about much-needed changes. The next year in Kheda, following disastrous floods, Mohandas rallied the people to stand firm in their resolve not to pay taxes on money they were unable to earn. The holdout lasted five long months, but Britain eventually gave in. In 1919, the activist began important talks with his country's Muslim leaders, asking that they band together with Hindus and other groups in pushing for relief from colonial rule. That same year, the British government passed the Rowlatt Act, by which any suspected terrorist in British India could be imprisoned for up to two years without a trial. The terrorism of which the government spoke had been on a small scale, but it was committed to responding to the growing anti-colonial movement.